EXPERIMENT 9

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Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-In Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

Aim

To explore AI-assisted features and built-in analytics using Zia in Zoho Creator by analyzing vehicle service request data, generating useful insights, creating visualizations, and improving the application dashboard to support better decision-making.

Objectives

- To review the application's existing dashboard (Service Center Vehicle Request Triage Dashboard) and the forms and reports whose data it uses.
- To use Zia, the AI developer assistant in Zoho Creator, to analyze the Service_Request_Form and Service_Request_Report data.
- To generate insights about service types and vehicle types from the existing service request records.
- To create charts and KPI panels that summarize the data using Zia-assisted suggestions.
- To understand how Zia suggests chart types, builds dashboard components, and surfaces patterns without manual scripting.

Software / Tools Required

- Zoho Creator (web-based low-code application development platform)
- Web browser with an active internet connection
- Zoho account with access to the application in Design and Access/Live mode

Introduction / Theory

Built-In Analytics in Zoho Creator

Zoho Creator ships with analytics components that turn form records into visual summaries without any separate BI tool. A Dashboard page can combine KPI panels, pie, column and stacked charts, and embedded reports in one view. All of these read live data directly from the

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application's forms, so the visuals update automatically as records are added or changed.

Zia - Zoho's AI Assistant

Zia is the AI layer built into the Zoho ecosystem, including Zoho Creator. Within Creator, the Zia Build Agent assists application builders by analyzing existing forms and reports, suggesting appropriate chart types, generating dashboard components, and surfacing patterns (such as which service type or vehicle type occurs most often) that would otherwise need manual analysis. Rather than requiring the developer to hand-build every chart, Zia-assisted suggestions speed up the process of turning a plain data table into a meaningful visual summary.

Key Concepts

Concept	Description
Dashboard	A custom page combining KPI panels, charts, and embedded reports into a single, auto-refreshing overview of application data.
Chart Widget	A visual element (pie, column, stacked column, etc.) bound to a report that summarises records by a chosen field, such as Service Type or Vehicle Type.
KPI Panel	A tile showing a single key figure, such as total requests, unique vehicles, oil changes or repairs.
Zia Build Agent	The AI developer inside Zoho Creator that accepts instructions in plain language and builds or improves forms, reports and dashboards.
Zia Insights	AI-assisted suggestions that recommend chart types, help assemble dashboard layouts, and highlight patterns in the underlying data.

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Application Specifications

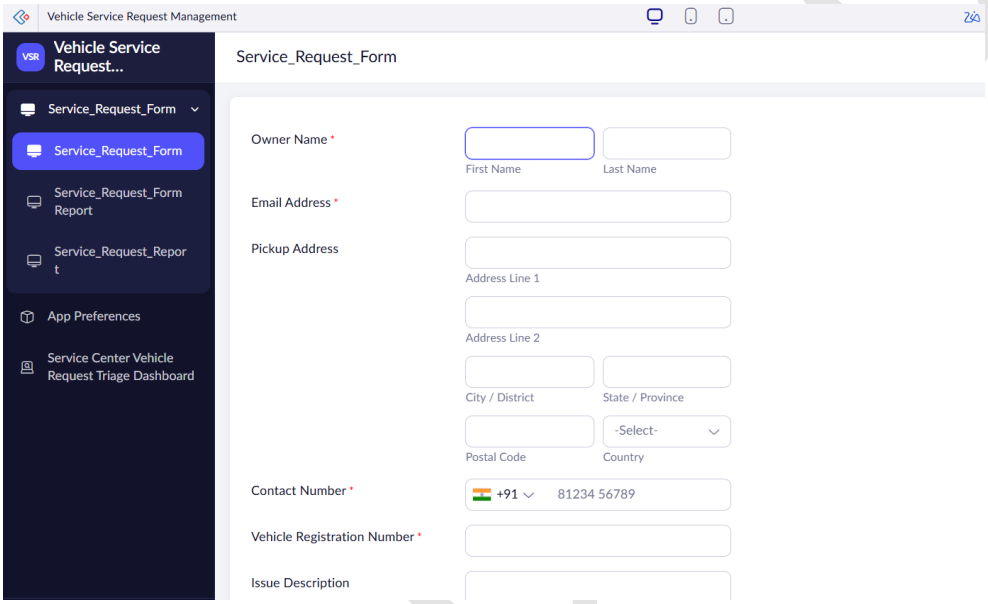
Parameter	Detail
Application Name	Vehicle Service & Repair Request Management
Primary Form	Service_Request_Form (Owner Name, Email Address, Pickup Address, Contact Number, Vehicle Registration Number, Issue Description, Odometer Reading, Vehicle Type, Service Type and related fields)
Reports	Service_Request_Form Report, Service_Request_Report
Dashboard	Service Center Vehicle Request Triage Dashboard
Zia-Generated KPI Panel	Total Requests, Unique Vehicles, Oil Changes, Repairs
Zia-Generated Charts	Service Requests by Type (column chart), Vehicle Type Distribution (pie chart), Service Type by Vehicle Type (stacked column chart)
Data Fields Analysed	Service_Type and Vehicle_Type from the existing records

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Procedure

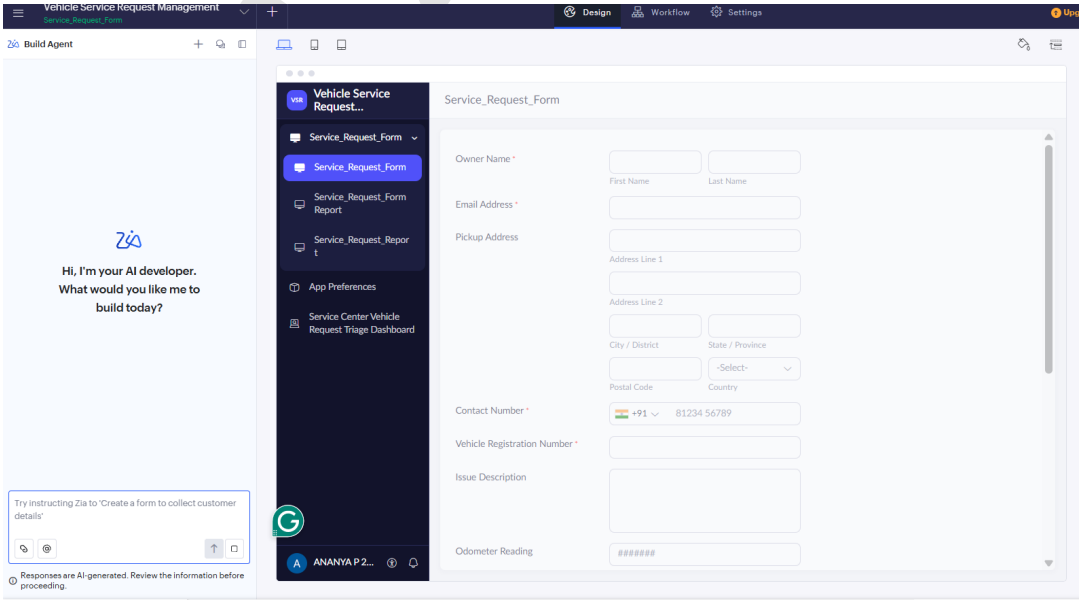
Step 1: Open the Application

The Vehicle Service & Repair Request Management application was opened in Zoho Creator, showing the Service_Request_Form, its reports, and the Service Center Vehicle Request Triage Dashboard.



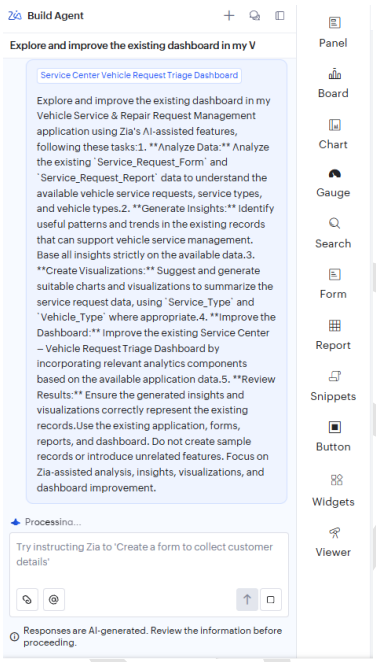
Step 2: Access Zia

The Zia Build Agent was opened from the Design view to explore its capabilities for data analysis and dashboard creation.



Step 3: Analyze Service Request Data

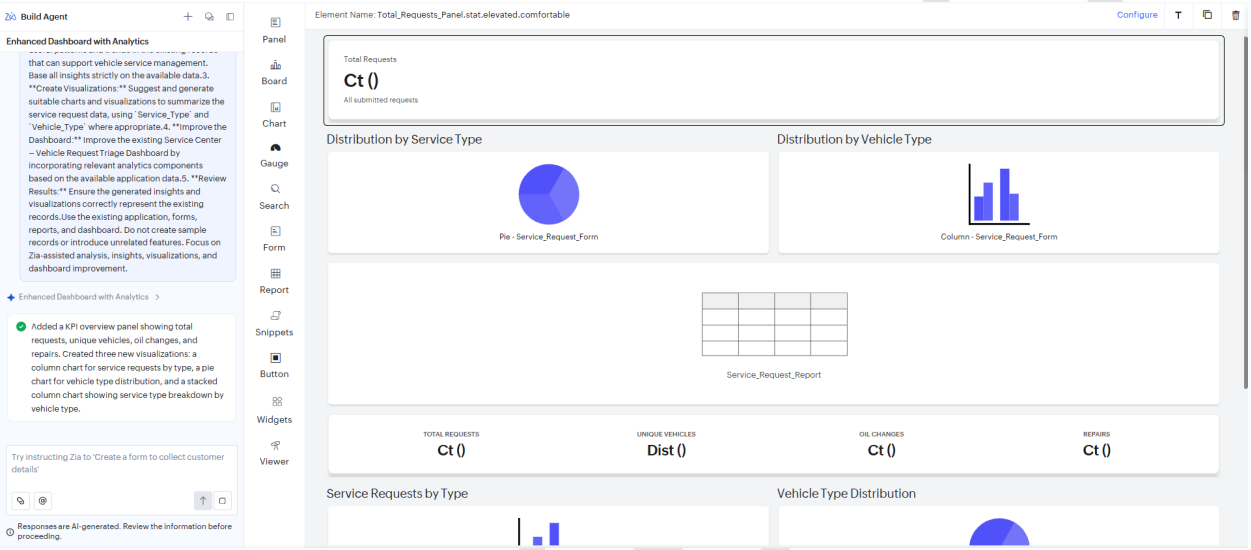
Zia was prompted to analyze the existing Service_Request_Form and Service_Request_Report data, including service requests, service types, and vehicle types, and to identify useful patterns and trends in the existing records.



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Step 4: Generate Insights and Visualizations

Zia processed the request and added a KPI overview panel showing total requests, unique vehicles, oil changes and repairs. It also created three new visualizations: a column chart for service requests by type, a pie chart for vehicle type distribution, and a stacked column chart showing service type breakdown by vehicle type.



Step 5: Create Visualizations

Zia was prompted to suggest and generate suitable charts using Service_Type and Vehicle_Type so that the service request data is easier to understand.

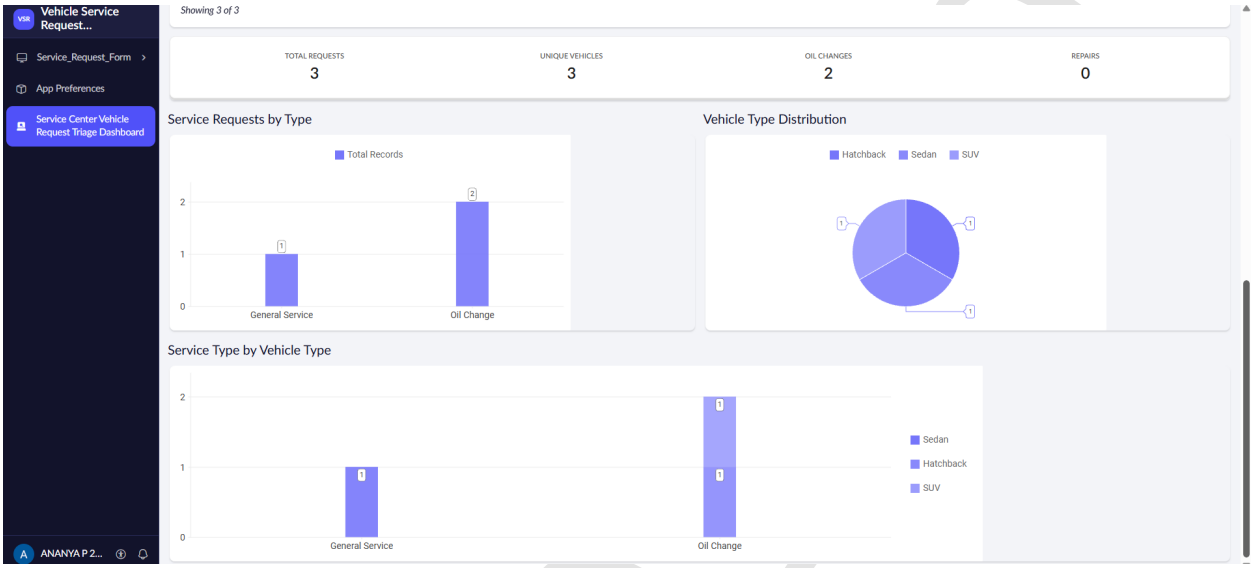
Step 6: Improve the Dashboard

The existing Service Center Vehicle Request Triage Dashboard was improved by adding the KPI panel and the charts generated by Zia, using only the available application data and fields.

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Step 7: Review the Results

The dashboard was opened in Access mode and the generated KPI figures and charts were reviewed to check whether they represented the existing service request records correctly: 3 total requests, 3 unique vehicles, 2 oil changes and 0 repairs.



Final Result

The AI-assisted features and built-in analytics capabilities of Zia in Zoho Creator were explored using the Vehicle Service & Repair Request Management application. Existing service request data was used to investigate insights, visualizations, and dashboard improvements.

The experiment demonstrated how AI-assisted analysis and visual reporting can help users understand service request information, identify useful patterns, and support data-driven decision-making in vehicle service management.

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